EXT. FARM - STOP SIGN - (10 YEARS BEFORE)

Amazing facility - full tack room, barn HVAC, etc. Silo of feed next to dozens of healthy animals. ATHARVA GRANDFATHER (70s SOUTH ASIAN INDIAN AMERICAN) pulls ropes to hoist family name sign atop barn door. The farm is in its prime.

ATHARVA GRANDFATHER
Finally, our name matters.

LAMBERT (O.C.)
Looks great!

YOUNG ATHARVA (6 year old kid) walks in with goat on leash. The goat chews and pulls the sign rope, sign falls on ground.

ATHARVA GRANDFATHER
The goat did that on purpose!

Child giggles, hugs goat.

YOUNG ATHARVA
I taught him that!

EXT. DENTON AIRPORT - NORTH TEXAS (PRESENT DAY)

LARRY LAMBERT (60s MEXICAN AMERICAN, farmer) leans against truck, holds sign “ATHARVA KOLARY”. Out of the regional airport steps ATHARVA KOLARY (18 - SOUTH ASIAN INDIAN AMERICAN), his Prada luggage bumps over the dirt, gold watch against manicured arm hair, his pristine John Deere trucker hat tag slaps him in the face as EDM blasts out of airpods.

LAMBERT
Figures. (to Atharva) Mahesh didn’t mention you’d have a purse. Or a dial-up modem out of your ears.

ATHARVA
You must be Larry-

LAMBERT
Mr. Lambert.

Lambert gets in the truck, Atharva struggles with luggage.

INT. TRUCK - ON ROUTE TO FARM

ATHARVA
I can’t wait to see my family’s great Kolary farm again.

LAMBERT
Eh, it used to be great.

ATHARVA
Guess you're gonna show me.

LAMBERT
I don't know if it'll be me. But something will kick your ass.

EXT. FARM - STOP SIGN

Truck to shit-hole farm. Gamily name falls to ground.

ATHARVA
Our name on the greatest goat yoga, farm-to-table Airbnb by summer.

LAMBERT
Got big dreams? Your grandad - same thing, every year. For 30 years.

ATHARVA
Well, I'm not Dadaji.

LAMBERT
That's what worries me.

Lambert hands Atharva a letter.

LAMBERT (CONT'D)
Your papa wanted you to have this.

Atharva reads the letter aloud -

ATHARVA GRANDFATHER
Atharva, wish I could be the one to show you the farm. But... the goats will show you, if you'll listen. It took me a while. -Dadaji Mahesh.

ATHARVA
"The goats will show you"?

LAMBERT
Mahesh and them goats.

Atharva folds up letter. Deep breath. Larry out of truck.

GOAT TOFU (O.C.)
This idiot kid has no idea.

ATHARVA
(to himself) I got this. I got this! I believe in myself.

GOAT REX (O.C.)
Showing up means being in charge. Waste of opposable thumbs?

ATHARVA
You know what!?

Atharva toward goats, not a human there, looks toward Lambert who's moving opposite. Lambert - unbothered, Atharva to goats-

EXT. FARM - (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Speed lines, orchestral swell, flash poses -

Atharva sees goats as they see - upright, anthropomorphized, break dance, flash poses, commanding competence-

NARRATOR
The guardians of the 'Kolary Farm'!

ATHARVA
No way.

REX
Shit. This one can hear us too.

BILLY
The last 3 humans had a combined .02% chance of farm success.

EXT. FARM (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva stands stunned. Rex slowly chews on the letter. Farm sign falls to the ground behind Atharva.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT I

EXT. FARM (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE) - CONTINUOUS

Atharva's eyes on 'half eaten' letter, then back at LAMBERT.

ATHARVA
The goats can talk?

LAMBERTF
They say 'baa' all the time.
(pause) I'll be back to feed.

Lambert toward truck.

ATHARVA
I'll do it. I should help.

LAMBERT
Works for me. (to himself) That
whole family and those goats.

Lambert is gone.

FAUN (O.C.)
5 dollars and show sheen that he
calls his mommy in 3 hours.

Goat snickers. Atharva turns toward goats-

EXT. PASTURE - (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

World sharpens, every detail in focus-

ATHARVA
Who are you?

Hard stop on Atharva, his clothes are now accentuated poser.

TOFU
Who are you? Who is anyone?-

REX (O.C.)
My name's Rex, buck of the farm.
We'll be your babysitters.

CARD : Rex (Boer) South African Market Goat, insecure leader.

REX (CONT'D)
Here's how this farm works. We eat
every morning 6a, every evening 6p.
Your grandfather never missed.

CARD: Feeding Schedule 6a & 6p MST. *early feed appreciated*

ATHARVA
My grandfather could hear you?

TOFU (O.C.)
All of our grandspirits!

Goat spirits of past howl from the ground up to the heavens.

REX
More on that later. Much later. Possibly never... (to Atharva) Back to - *Feeding Instructions*!

CARD: 1) Tack Room, Holds Feed 12x6 wing of barn *Schematics*

REX (O.C.) (CONT'D)
One. Get food out of the tack room.

Memory montage of feeding instructions on bags, of grandfather feeding goats, of goats showing feed buckets, etc

REX (CONT'D)
Two. Correct portion for correct animal. If you mix up the food, someone gets sick. More than likely Tofu due to his digestive system.

CARD: 2) Right Feed - Right Competitor. *Animal buckets*

REX (CONT'D)
Three. Put the correct feed buckets into wheel barrow. You underfeed, we lose weight. You overfeed, we can't compete. You don't want to see Tofu not "regular".

CARD: 3) Wheel Barrow, *coordinates of path to trough on map*

ATHARVA
Buckets, got it. (pause) Compete?

FAUN (O.C.)
The county fair in October.

REX
This is Faun. The blue ribbon of our herd-

CARD : Faun (Alpine) Breeding Champion Goat, beauty.

FAUN
We win the or the farm goes under.

TOFU
I'm Tofu. HI!

CARD : Tofu (Pygmy) Small Mighty Unpredictable.

TOFU (CONT'D)
Let's attack the neighbors farm!

TOFU raises an army of squirrels in matching war suits.

BILLY (O.C.)
I'm Billy. Just remember six o'clock, right food, county fair-

CARD: Billy (Fainting Goat), Smart and Scared.

TOFU
(to Billy) Boo!

BILLY (Fainting Goat), freezes and falls to the ground.

ATHARVA
So I'm in charge of the groceries.

Atharva walks around the pasture confidently.

ATHARVA (CONT'D)
And, where's the pantry?

TOFU
(laughing) PANTRY?

FAUN
A pantry is where rich people keep their feelings.

BILLY
Uh, this is gonna be a disaster, I'll let Bonnie know.

REX
(to Billy) Wait. (to Atharva) Step one - tack room.

ATHARVA
Of course. I was... testing you.

EXT. PASTURE - FEED TROUGH (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva walks toward pigs and chickens-

ATHARVA
Well, I see half of you all are already here. Why don’t we all-

OINK. BA-COCK. Animals wonder off - ignoring Atharva.

ATHARVA (CONT’D)
(to himself) What is going on?

He stands overwhelmed. Pulls out his phone, calls MOM.

RING. RING. Voicemail beep.

ATHARVA (CONT’D)
Hey Mom, it's me. I just...I've been here like three hours and nothing is going well. Except, the goats communication skills.

He looks at Dadaji Mahesh’s crumpled letter in his hand.

ATHARVA (CONT’D)
I know you and Dad think I should come home. Take that job at his firm, get married, go live in the burbs. But I can’t. Not yet.

His voice cracks.

ATHARVA (CONT’D)
Grandfather's letter says "the goats will show you”. I'm trying to listen, I am, but I don't... I don't know what I'm doing. (pause) He trusted me with forty years of his life. And maybe you and Dad don’t get why that matters... the farm was everything to him. And he was everything to me.

He wipes his eyes.

ATHARVA (CONT’D)
I just need to prove I'm not some kid who drifts around. Dadaji believed in me. (pause) I’ll figure it out. I have to. Love you.

Footsteps behind Atharva.

REX (O.C.)
Your mom will be impressed when you tell her you let everyone starve.

Atharva turns to-

EXT. PASTURE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

ATHARVA
It’s impolite to eaves drop.

Rex looks at Atharva blankly.

ATHARVA (O.C.) (CONT’D)
Why didn’t the pigs talk to me?

REX
They heard ya. They just didn’t want to talk to you. Pigs and chickens are the least social of all the animals, don’t mind them.

MEREDITH, (chicken) steps up too close to Atharva.

MEREDITH
Not all of us. I’m Meredith. Love your arm hair. Everyone’s talking about you. You staying long?

Meredith puts arm around Atharva’s shoulder. Atharva blushes.

MEREDITH (CONT’D)
(whispers to Atharva) Rex hasn't slept since your grandfather died. Don't tell him I told you.

Atharva leaves the pasture and up in the opposite direction of the barn. The animals laugh. Atharva changes direction.

EXT. TACK ROOM (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva lowers his headphones that blare EDM.

ATHARVA
Found the tack room.

CARD: 1) Tack Room, Holds Feed 12x6 wing of barn *Schematics*

Atharva reaches for the door handle. WOOF WOOF. BONNIE, the overzealous farm security, blocks him.

BONNIE
Unvetted. No clearance. No credentials. (growl)

ATHARVA
I own the farm.

Behind Atharva coyotes can’t help but bump to the EDM sounds.

BONNIE
(to coyotes) You absolutely have no clearance. (bark bark)

Bonnie chases after the dancing coyotes.

INT. TACK ROOM (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Door swings open. Saddles fall off the wall as dust scatters the light.

Rats scurry all around the sides of the room. Huge metal trash cans, chains around them - greasy old locks make up the majority of the room.

ATHARVA
Bingo.

A huge wall full of trimmers, harnesses, buckets of screws, and over 60 keys with confusing hieroglyphics.

ATHARVA (CONT’D)
Un-bingo.

INT. TACK ROOM (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Speed lines into pop punk music.

REX
Where ya starting? Will the hero solve the mystery.

Atharva grabs a random key, it doesn’t fit on the first bin. Tries a second key, doesn’t fit.

REX (CONT’D)
There are 40 keys and 6 locks.

ATHARVA
One in seven chance.

Atharva tries keys, super speed, none fit. Rex with popcorn-

REX
Our hero failed combinatorics, a lifelong pattern of failure.

Atharva tries key after key after key.

ATHARVA
(furious) Fine! Which one is it.

REX
Third from bottom.

ATHARVA
My system of elimination would have gotten me there.

REX
(sighs) You can read the bags for how much and for which animals.

CARD: 2) Right Feed - Right Competitor. *Animal buckets*

Montage of Atharva weighing the feed out of the bags, comparing the buckets, etc.

REX (CONT'D)
And now into the wheel barrow!

CARD: 3) Wheel Barrow, *coordinates of trough on map*

All food is in the wheel barrow, it sparkles with completion. They walk out of the tack room to-

EXT. TACK ROOM (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

The main gate left open to the pasture. Coyotes stand in the path to the feed trough. Door closes behind them and locks.

BILLY
0% chance of this going well.

END OF ACT I

ACT II

EXT. BARN - DUSK (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

IMPACT SHAKE - ground trembles, coyotes pace path from barn to feed troughs, ready to ambush the wheel barrow caravan.

FAUN
This looks stunning, might as well give up and get beauty rest.

CARD : County Fair Oct 23rd. T minus 72 days. *ribbon*

BILLY
We'll never get through the coyotes.

Coyotes growl as Atharva looks up at the power lines going from the barn to the edge of the property, directly over...

ATHARVA
We don't have to go through them. We'll go over them.

BILLY
I hope you never explain that sentence or continue that thought.

ATHARVA
We throw them a concert. EDM, lights, fog. While they're distracted, we zip-line the wheel barrow over their heads and into the trough.

REX
That's the dumbest thing I've ever—

TOFU
I LOVE IT! Can we add fire?

ALL
No!

CARD : *zip-line* invented in 1970s but not for wheelbarrows.

The electrical wires sparkle.

EXT. BARN - CONTINUOUS (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva waves stick in dirt going over elaborate plan.

ATHARVA
We split into teams - Team Panthers - Faun, Billy, and Rex will zipline the wheel barrow over the coyote lookout on the trail.

CARD : Team Panthers - Zip-line configuration. Wheel, etc.

BILLY
Will it hold that weight?

ATHARVA
It has to. How hard can this be?

All the animals sigh.

ATHARVA (CONT'D)
Tofu, Meredith, and Bonnie, Team Eagles - handle security, ticketing, and marketing to the EDM show. I'll be the DJ.

MEREDITH
Why are both team names predators?

ATHARVA
To show our fight and determination!

FAUN
And our demise. $20 parylay on the Panthers.

SPLIT SCREEN MONTAGE -

EXT. BARN - TELEPHONE POLE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

REX
(to Atharva) If this doesn't work, we're blaming you.

ATHARVA
When it DOES work, you're all gonna apologize.

CARD : +100 Farmer Points. Acquired farm readiness badge.

BILLY
(to himself) We're all gonna die. This is how we die.

EXT. BARN - PASTURE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Tofu runs, box full of fireworks, some already lit and going.

TOFU
I'm getting the fireworks!

BONNIE
NO fireworks!

EXT. BARN ROOF - TELEPHONE POLE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

FAUN
This pulley gonna hold the weight?

ATHARVA
It has to.

EXT. BARN ROOF - TELEPHONE POLE (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva's phone buzzes, it's mom. He looks hard at phone, then the two goats butting heads on top of the roof.

EXT. BARN - PASTURE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Background blurs, goats crisp -

TOFU
What if we add GLITTER?

MEREDITH
Where would you GET glitter?

Tofu holds up a bag of glitter.

BONNIE
Marketing is complete, should have a full house. Got this out.

Bonnie holds up "EDM House Party *new ownership*" postcards.

EXT. BARN - TELEPHONE POLE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Rex and Atharva hoist wheelbarrow with feed taught to wire.

REX
The weight capacity is only—

ATHARVA
Then we use TWO cables!

Rex tenses two cables from the telephone pole wire.

EXT. BARN - PASTURE - EDM CONCERT (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

The EDM concert outside the barn is a line full of coyotes.

ATHARVA
LOOK AT THIS! We're geniuses! This is gonna work!

BILLY
You don't know that—

ATHARVA
I do KNOW that! It’s perfect.

Line of coyotes from every part of the county.

COYOTE
I’m drawn to the sparkles.

COYOTE 2
I want to set expectations after the Coyote Selena concert - Bidi Bidi Not Good.

Tofu rens past with box full of exploding fireworks.

TOFU
Seventeen explosions!

BONNIE
Seventeen violations of safety.

Stage lights and fog cut the clear prairie sky. In the distance, wheelbarrow steadies on lines, Rex holds the rope.

FAUN
It actually looks amazing. Looks like I need to pay up.

BONNIE
So many outstanding citations.

ATHARVA
(to coyotes) Hey! You guys ready for a SHOW?

EXT. PASTURE (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

BEN BAZAN (50s Farm Friend), sees the light show behind the barn and Atharva on top the barn roof talking to a goat with a wheelbarrow suspended atop the telephone pole.

BEN
You Atharva? Mahesh's kid?

EDM blares behind the barn. Atharva nods his head

BEN (CONT'D)
Alright then.

Ben shakes his head drives off.

EXT. PASTURE - EDM STAGE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Close-up intensity of Atharva -

EDM blasts. Lights pulse. Bonnie opens security gates. Coyotes move toward stage.

EXT. BARN - TELEPHONE POLE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Wheelbarrow launches on zipline, travels smoothly overhead. BOTH parts of plan - succeeding.

REX
I can't believe it.

EXT. PASTURE - EDM STAGE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

DJ Atharva dropping the beat. Coyotes rave-ing, going crazy.

ATHARVA
(to crowd) Thank you everyone for coming out. As we knew this would be a hit!

The crowd goes wild.

COYOTE
Best concert since the heifer pasture's Moooo-town Mondays.

BILLY
(to Atharva) The wheelbarrow! It's almost there! It's almost there!

ATHARVA
(to crowd) And THAT'S how you move a wheelbarrow, people!

He gestures broadly toward the barn, CALLING THE COYOTE'S ATTENTION to the wheelbarrow. Tofu turns the spotlight toward Rex. The coyotes mouths begin to water.

EXT. PASTURE (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Rex panics, loses grip, cable sags.

Tofu's sparkler sets concert stage on FIRE.

Concert coyotes run at sagging wheelbarrow, slipping food.

Atharva turns from the crowd, finally looks at sagging wheelbarrow. He stops mid-performance.

ATHARVA
Oh no—

Too late. Coyotes are already nipping at the wheelbarrow.

Billy faints then wakes to disaster, faints again.

Cable SNAPS. Wheelbarrow crashes. Feed spills everywhere. Coyotes swarm. Bonnie chases them. Chaos.

EXT. PASTURE (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Every hoof-step and paw print echoes.

EDM stage burning. Half the feed stolen. Wheelbarrow broken. Coyotes nipping at leftovers. Animals are hungry, angry, disappointed.

REX
(to Atharva) ... Worth it?

Atharva offers no defense.

CARD: "5:55 PM MST" Headlights in distance. Lambert's truck approaching. 5 minutes until disaster seen.

EXT. PASTURE - CONTINUOUS (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva stands. Looks at disaster. Headlights growing.

ATHARVA
Okay. Okay okay okay. (to the goats) Tell me what to do.

REX
What?

ATHARVA
You know this farm. I don't. Tell me what to do and I'll do it.

Beat. Goats look at each other.

END OF ACT II

ACT III

EXT. PASTURE (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva stands. Fire smoldering, feed scattered, wheelbarrow broken, Lambert's headlights in the distance.

ATHARVA
Tell me.

EXT. PASTURE - (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Rex's iris contracting. Pull out to a full fight pose-

REX
Time for professionals!
On my mark!

Split screen of each professional fight pose in following-

NARRATOR
For over 3 centuries the Farm
Professionals have dealt with any
confrontation in their way.
Specialized learned behaviors-

Bonnie speed runs citation paperwork. Faun in science costume examines feed pellets. Billy in blue collar garb carries feed buckets across their horns. Tofu EDM concert grip costume.

REX
Bonnie. Sweep the perimeter.
Nothing with teeth gets through.

CARD: BONNIE - SWEEPER. *SWAT Radius diagram. Kill zone marked.*

REX (CONT'D)
Faun. Sorter. Use your acute smell
of animal feed blend. Only
salvageable, fair-worthy feed!

CARD: FAUN - SORTER. *contamination threshold test results*

FAUN
I'll do it. But you all owe me 40
for the mommy call.

REX
Billy. Bucket Relay. Strength in
carrying across enemy territory!

CARD: BILLY - RUNNER. *dotted line past skulls to trough*

REX (CONT'D)
Tofu! Put dirt on fire. Atharva will assist you with water.

CARD: TOFU - DOESN'T CARE. DOES WHAT WILL. *fire diagram*

REX (CONT'D)
Atharva - junior fire containment.

ATHARVA
I'M READY!

REX
You hold the hose...

A limp hose, with spurts of water.

CARD: ATHARVA - ONBOARDING. *hold water spurts*

Back to Rex's iris contracting. Pull out to a full fight pose-

REX (CONT'D)
We have done this hundreds of times before in worse circumstances. We have 4 minutes - move!

CARD: Save Feed. *scattered feed schematics*. *Lambert 3 min*

NARRATOR
The Farm Professionals!

EXT. PASTURE - CONTINUOUS (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Photomontage - professional expert photoshoots

PANEL 1 - BONNIE (Perimeter):

Bonnie writes a ticket for the first coyote. Coyote YELPS, then retreats. She spots coyote 2. Bonnie skids to a stop, in front of coyote 2. Pupils dilate. Ticket with pen ready.

PANEL 2 - FAUN (Sort Station):

Faun "scientist" steps into the scattered feed. Her pristine coat immediately catches dust. She WINCES.

FAUN
They'll pay in bookie fees.

But her nose goes to work — sniffing, sorting, pushing contaminated feed aside with surgical precision.

PANEL 3 - TOFU (Fire):

Tofu stands before smoldering EDM stage and Atharva. He looks at pile of dirt. Looks at fire. Looks at pile of dirt.

Then he starts DIGGING. Not putting dirt on the fire — digging a trench. A massive, unnecessary, architecturally ambitious trench around the entire fire zone.

PANEL 4 - BILLY (Runner):

Sweat and strength carrying buckets. A lizard spooks Billy. Billy faints.

PANEL 5 - ATHARVA (Hose):

Atharva holds the hose. Water hits fire ember. He stands there. Others are intensely doing their jobs around him. But, he watches them work.

EXT. PASTURE - TROUGHS (GOAT PERSPECTIVE)

Billy at the end of his fainting run. Faun is filthy and furious. Feed is separated in buckets. The system is WORKING.

SLAM. The gate to the trough is tangled on the cable from the zipline disaster which is wrapped around the gate lock — the main trough is locked shut. Other animals locked out of the trough, screaming and complaining.

Goats gather at the gate. They try to push it. Headbutt it.

BILLY
We need human hands.

Everyone turns to Atharva. Crowd is silent. Atharva is stupidly sputtering the hose on the final embers.

REX
Kid. Come here.

Atharva stares as lightyears pass him by. Atharva drops the hose and walks to the gate. The goats step aside for him. They look at him with need.

CARD: *ATHARVA - PROMOTED TO “GATE OPERATOR”.*

Atharva's hands SHAKE. Cable wrapped around the latch, the fallen zipline rig’s weight pulls taught the other end.

He grabs the cable. Pulls. It doesn't move.

He repositions. Wraps it around his forearm. Pulls harder. His arm hair reaches for energy around him.

ATHARVA
(straining)
I got it — I can —

EXT. PASTURE - TROUGH (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

An 18 year-old kid in burnt clothes pulling a steel cable with soft arm hair that has never done manual labor.

He can't get leverage. He braces his foot against the post — slips. Tries again. Cable bites into his arm. He howls.

He doesn't know how to position himself, not strong enough. He doesn't know which strand or knot. Animals stand watching.

CARD: Excuses: 4. Results: 0.

Atharva stops pulling. Steps back. Looks at the cable. Looks at his hands — red marks, blood from the cable.

ATHARVA
I can't... I don't think I can —

Silence. Lambert's headlights sweep across the pasture.

Rex walks past Atharva. Doesn't look at him. Lines up with the gate post at an angle — 10 years of being on the farm, knowing which boards give, knowing where the weight sits. One headbutt. The right post. The right angle. The gate shudders. BAM. Cable goes slack. Latch releases. Gate swings open.

Billy and Faun move the buckets in. Animals push toward the trough. Eating. Atharva stands to the side. Watching. The farm working without him.

EXT. DRIVEWAY - MOMENTS LATER (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Lambert's truck. Engine cuts. He steps out slow.

Scorch marks where EDM stage was. Broken wheelbarrow in pieces by the barn. Tofu's glitter, on everything.

Lambert walks to trough. Animals eating. Looks at portions — not perfect, not full, but enough. Lambert hides pride.

Looks at Atharva. Soot-covered. Cable burns on his arm hair. Hose at his feet sputtering. No smile.

LAMBERT
Animals fed?

Atharva opens his mouth. We see it — pupils grow with cockeyed optimism. He stops. Closes mouth. Looks at goats.

ATHARVA
The goats did it. I held a hose.

Lambert looks at him. Looks at disaster. Looks at fed animals. His face shifts — no smile, no approval-

LAMBERT
Your grandad said something like that. Took him bout 8 years though.

He walks to his truck. Opens the tailgate. Pulls out bags of feed and sets them on the ground. Gets in the truck. Pauses.

LAMBERT (CONT'D)
Same time tomorrow?

ATHARVA
...Yeah.

Lambert drives off.

TAG:

INT. BARN - TACK ROOM - 3:30AM (HUMAN PERSPECTIVE)

Atharva puts away hose alone. Nothing left in him. Picking up scattered bags, hanging saddle that fell. Behind the saddle, on the wall — a faded photo. His grandfather. Dadaji Mahesh, 19, in front of his barn. Brand new, fresh paint, sign straight, grandad terrified.

Atharva stares at it. Touches the photo. Puts it in his pocket. Footsteps. Hooves on concrete. Atharva turns. Rex stands in the barn doorway.

ATHARVA
I know. Feed at 6 am.

Rex starts to walk out the barn.

ATHARVA (CONT'D)
Rex?

Rex stops.

ATHARVA (CONT'D)
Thanks for — today. For taking over when I —

Rex leaves. Atharva alone. Looks at the barn around him. Broken equipment, scorch marks, Tofu's trench, glitter.

But the animals are fed. The lights are on in the barn.

CARD: *County Fair: 72 days. Farm debt: $847,000. Coyotes repelled: 3. Atharva's farming skill: 2/100.*

END OF PILOT